

WWE '12 – JUST BRING IT!

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Wrestling game WWE '12 is developed by Yuke's and published by THQ. From WWF Smackdown to WWE Smackdown vs Raw and now to WWE, this becomes the first game under the WWE series. It's also the 14th game in the combined series. WWE '12 has been one of the much hyped games of the series and a game we've been eagerly waiting to get our hands on. So how does it stack up to all the hype? Let's find out.

WWE '12 sees some major highs and lows. Let's kick things off with the major highs of the game. When we witnessed Undertaker's entrance, we were absolutely speechless. The music, the pyro technique – the entire entrance package is so minutely perfected that sometimes it feels as if we're watching a live episode of WWE. The modeling of the wrestlers has become more refined and is almost perfect. It's by far the best-looking WWE game ever. There's no denying that we were absolutely blown away by its presentation. Further, the game brings a new animation system, what THQ calls as the "Predator Technology". The animations have become super fluid, thus making the game actions superfast and intense. The combat moves that wrestlers perform have become smoother and the combination moves seamlessly blend into each other so as to give one smooth action scene. The transition time between attacks and reversals is so less that it reminds us of the superfast *Smackdown: Here Comes the Pain*. At times the animations seem so fluid, that it feels surrealistic.

Another big addition to the game, which we give a big thumbs up to, is the new limb targeting system. The limb targeting system lets you deal damage to specific areas of the body. This is really useful if you're playing a wrestler with submission as his finisher. You can do some real damage to your opponent's legs or hands and then finish him off with your submis-

sion move. Damaging the head of the opponent will make him prone to be groggy, and thus let you perform more groggy grappling moves. However, this is where the goodies end. The gameplay is seriously flawed. The offensive gameplay is absolutely perfect – be it the offensive strikes, grapples or Irish whips – no complains here. It's the defensive gameplay i.e. the reversals that totally sucks. This is one of the most important aspects of the gameplay but we thoroughly hate the way it functions. To successfully perform a reversal move, you have to press the right button the very second the game prompts you to perform it. Even a split-second delay and you won't be able to pull off the reversals. The window of opportunity you get to perform these reversals can be deemed as nil and to add to your misery these reversals prompts don't appear with every move. After a point in the match – where you're being flogged by the AI who, by the way, can perform a reversal at his will – the lack of ease of performing a reversal makes the game extremely annoying to an extent where you feel like shutting it down. Another letdown is the game's story mode – The Road to Wrestlemania. You get to play three chapters, which revolves around Sheamus, Triple H and a custom wrestler you create; however, the matches aren't that stimulating and often carry strict objectives making it very difficult to play freely.

Few mentionable additions that make the gameplay somewhat better are the "Dynamic Comeback" feature and new wake up taunt. The "Dynamic Comeback" feature lets the losing superstars perform a few quick comeback attacks and avoid a pin. The new wake-up taunts bring a downed opponent to his feet for a finishing move; for e.g. Randy Orton bangs the stage prompting the opponent to get up and then delivers his finishing move, "RKO". The customisation options including creating wrestlers, arenas, moves, entrance sequences are almost endless, and this will be one of most loved features of the game. *

Verdict:

WWE '12, like we said, has some major highs and some major lows. The game without doubt nailed presentation and graphics. The endless customisation options will definitely consume a lot of your time and is a definite hit. However, the game fails to deliver the gameplay required to support such sublime presentation and graphics – the annoying reversal system totally destroys the otherwise perfect WWE experience. We really hope the next installment of the game rectifies this major flaw.

Ratings:

- » Genre: Professional wrestling sports
- » Developer: Yuke's
- » Publisher: THQ
- » Price: ₹2,399

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